

# *Nicolas's Biking Playbook*

*A picture guide to the bike, the moves, the rules of the road, and the joy of the ride.*

*Welcome, Nicolas. You already know how to ride a bike — or you're about to. Now we're going to learn everything that goes with it — every part of the bike, every rule of the road, every skill that makes a rider good. Take your time. Look at the pictures. Watch a video. Try a drill. Biking is not about being perfect. It's about getting curious, building good habits, and finding the joy of two wheels and the open road. And the best part — biking is a freedom you can have for the rest of your life.*

## What's inside this playbook



### The Bike

A picture map of a bike with every part named — frame, brakes, gears, helmet, all of it.



### Rules & Safety

10 rules of the road. Helmet always. Hand signals. ABC bike check. The basics of safe riding.



### Skills & Moves

Starting. Stopping. Steering. Shifting gears. Hand signals. The moves every rider knows.



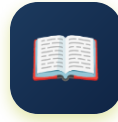
### Lesson Plans

Four lesson formats that roll in over the year — from driveway basics to longer rides on a bike path.



### **Fun Games**

Brother games. Slow race. Cone slalom.  
Obstacle course. Things to play in the  
driveway or yard.



### **Your Biking Story**

A picture story about a bike ride day — what  
to expect, what to do, what to feel.

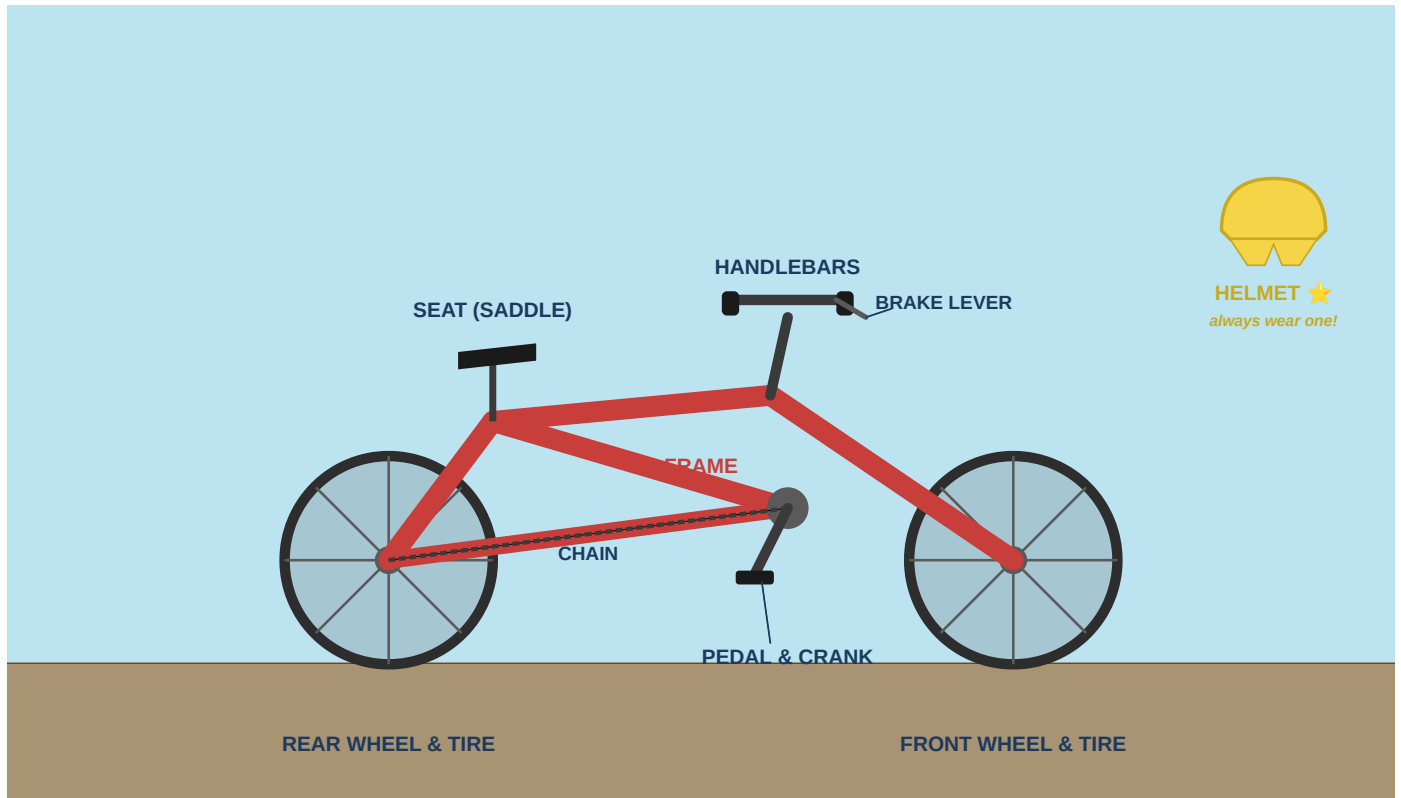


### **Biking Songs**

Custom Suno songs made just for you.  
Listen before a ride to get ready, or after a  
great day on the bike.

*'' The best rider is not the fastest one. The best rider is the one who keeps showing up,  
keeps building skills, and remembers to smile after a great ride. ''*

Every part of a bike has a name and a job. Knowing the parts helps you understand how to ride, how to fix small problems, and what to ask for at the shop.



## The parts and what they do

### Helmet ★

The MOST important piece. Two finger widths above the eyebrows, straps in a V around the ears, snug under the chin. Wear it EVERY ride.

💬 "Helmet on first."

### Frame

The metal triangle that holds everything together. Has a top tube, down tube, seat tube, and stays.

💬 "The skeleton."

### Wheels & tires

Two of them. Tires need air — squeeze them every ride. If you can squish them easy, they need a pump.

💬 "Check the air."

### Spokes

The thin wires from the hub to the rim of each wheel. Like a wagon wheel.

💬 *"Keep them clear."*

### Handlebars

What you hold to steer. Two hands on the grips. Keep them light — don't squeeze too hard.

💬 *"Light hands."*

### Brake levers

On the handlebars. Right hand = REAR brake (usually). Left hand = FRONT brake (usually). Squeeze BOTH together to stop smoothly.

💬 *"Both levers together."*

### Seat (saddle)

Where you sit. Should be at the height where your leg is almost straight when the pedal is at the bottom.

💬 *"Almost straight leg."*

### Pedals

What you push with your feet. Push DOWN through the ball of your foot, not the arch.

💬 *"Ball of foot."*

### Crank

The arms that hold the pedals. They turn around in circles to drive the chain.

💬 *"Round and round."*

### Chain

The metal links that connect the crank to the rear wheel. Don't touch with bare hands — chains get greasy.

💬 *"Greasy. Don't touch."*

## Biking grows with you

Biking has stages. Each stage opens up new places to ride. There is no rush. Every rider started where you are.



### Driveway Stage

**What you learn here:** balance, starting, stopping, steering. The driveway is the perfect classroom. No traffic, no surprises.

💬 *"Master the basics."*



### Path Stage

**What you learn here:** riding on bike paths and quiet streets. Hand signals. Riding next to Daddy. Longer distances.

💬 *"Stay smart, stay seen."*



## Trail Stage

**What you learn here:** riding on dirt, going over roots and rocks, climbing hills, descending. Your brain reads the trail one move ahead.

💬 *"Eyes ahead."*



## Rider Stage

**What you learn here:** longer rides, route planning, basic maintenance, riding with friends. By now your skills, your safety habits, and your spirit are all yours.

💬 *"My bike. My ride. Forever."*

## Watch & learn



### How to Ride a Bike (for kids)

An intro to the basics: balance, starting, stopping.

▶ Watch



### Bike Safety for Kids

Helmet fit, hand signals, road rules — kid-friendly version.

▶ Watch

*Biking has clear rules — for safety AND for fun. Once you know them, every ride is better. These keep you safe on the driveway, the bike path, and the road.*



### 1. Helmet on, every ride

No helmet = no riding. Two finger widths above the eyebrows, straps in a V around the ears, snug under the chin (one finger between strap and chin). Replace after any crash.

*"Helmet first. Always."*

▶ Watch



### 2. Ride WITH traffic

On the road, ride in the SAME direction as cars. Stay as far right as is safe. Single file when riding with someone else.

*"Same way as cars."*

▶ Watch

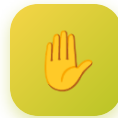


### 3. Stop at stop signs

Bikes follow car rules. STOP at every stop sign. Look LEFT, then RIGHT, then LEFT AGAIN before crossing.

*"Look both ways twice."*

▶ Watch



### 4. Hand signals

**LEFT turn:** stick left arm STRAIGHT out.

**RIGHT turn:** left arm BENT up at the elbow (or right arm straight out). **STOP:** left arm bent DOWN at the elbow.

*"Tell people what you're doing."*

▶ Watch

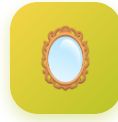


## 5. Look before you turn

Always look OVER YOUR SHOULDER before changing direction. Then signal. Then turn. Look-signal-turn — that order.

 *"Look. Signal. Turn."*

 Watch



## 6. Stay seen

Wear bright colors (especially yellow). Use lights at night or in the rain. Make eye contact with drivers at intersections.

 *"Bright clothes. Eye contact."*

 Watch



## 7. Sidewalks & bike paths

On the sidewalk: SLOW DOWN. Walkers always have right of way. Say "On your left!" before passing. On bike paths: same — slow down for walkers.

 *"Say 'on your left.'"*

 Watch



## 8. Two hands on the bars

No riding "no hands" until you're MUCH more experienced. Keep both hands on the handlebars, ready to brake.

 *"Two hands. Always."*

 Watch





## 9. Bike check before EVERY ride

**A-B-C check:** **A**ir in the tires (squeeze them). **B**reaks work (squeeze the levers). **C**hain on (look down). Takes 30 seconds. Saves crashes.

💬 "A. B. C. Then go."

▶ Watch



## 10. Be a great rider

Wave to other riders. Help if someone falls. Don't show off to make others feel small. Biking is more fun when everyone is welcome.

💬 "Wave. Help. Be kind."

▶ Watch

▶ Watch

*''A bike is freedom on two wheels. The rules are not to slow you down — they're what let you ride further, faster, and for the rest of your life. ''*

## Watch & learn the rules

Short videos that explain how the game is played. Watch a couple before your first session.



### Kids Bike Safety

▶ Watch



### Hand Signals

▶ Watch



## **ABC Bike Check**

▶ Watch



## **Bike Rules of the Road**

▶ Watch

Every move on a bike has a name and a feel. You already know how to balance. Now let's name the moves and learn the secrets.

## The 6 essential moves



### Starting (the push-off)

Pedal up to the 2 o'clock position. Foot **ON** the pedal. Push **DOWN** as you push off with the other foot. The down-push is what gets you going.

💬 "Pedal at 2. Push down."

▶ Watch



### Stopping (smooth)

Squeeze **BOTH** brake levers **TOGETHER** — equal pressure on each. Slide back on the seat. Foot down only **AFTER** you've stopped.

💬 "Both brakes. Foot last."

▶ Watch



### Turning

**LOOK** where you want to go (your body follows your eyes). Lean slightly into the turn. Smooth gentle steer — don't yank the bars.

💬 "Look. Lean. Glide."

▶ Watch



### Balancing slow

Looking ahead helps balance more than looking down. The slower you go, the harder it gets. Keep some pedal pressure on at all times.

💬 "Eyes up. Keep pedaling."

▶ Watch

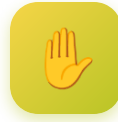


## Shifting gears

**LOW gear** (easy) = for hills going UP. **HIGH gear** (hard) = for flat or downhill. Shift while pedaling. Don't shift while standing still.

💬 *"Up = low. Flat = high."*

▶ Watch



## Signaling

Stick your arm out for left turn. Bent up for right turn. Bent down for stop. Practice in the driveway before you need them.

💬 *"Tell people first."*

▶ Watch

▶ Watch

## The Helmet Check (every ride)

### The 2-V-1 check:

- **2 fingers** above your eyebrows — that's how high the front of the helmet sits.
- **V shape** — the straps come together to form a V right under your earlobes.
- **1 finger** between the chin strap and your chin — snug, but not choking.

💬 *"2, V, 1. Every ride."*

## The Athletic Bike Position

### Before every ride, find this position:

- Pedals at 3 and 9 o'clock (level).
- Knees slightly bent.
- Elbows slightly bent (don't lock).
- Eyes UP, looking 20+ feet ahead.
- Butt slightly off the seat for bumps.

💬 *"Knees soft. Eyes far."*

## The Five Steps of Every Stop



### See it coming

Look ahead. If you might need to stop, START thinking about it now.

💬 *"Plan ahead."*

▶ Watch



### Signal

Stick your hand out (the STOP signal) so others know.

💬 *"Tell them."*

▶ Watch



### Squeeze BOTH brakes

Equal pressure on both levers. Front brake does most of the stopping; rear keeps you stable.

💬 *"Both together."*

▶ Watch



### Shift weight back

Slide your butt slightly back on the seat. This keeps the front wheel grounded.

💬 *"Weight back."*

▶ Watch



### Foot down

Only after the bike has STOPPED. Pick your stronger leg. Put that foot flat on the ground.

💬 *"Foot last."*

▶ Watch

▶ Watch

*The structure stays the same so Nicolas can predict what's coming. The content inside the structure changes so it never gets boring. Four lesson formats roll in over the year — one at a time, never all at once. Each format scales to a 60-min lesson with Coach or a 30-min practice with Daddy.*

## Why formats, not single-skill weeks

Nicolas needs predictable structure. He also needs novelty — but novelty inside the structure, not novelty AS the structure. So instead of "this week we do uppies, next week we do dribbles," every practice follows the same shape: warm up → play → new skill → play with skill → drill → clean up. The shape is the constant. What goes inside each block is what evolves.

Built-in transitions (water cooler, ball machine adjustments, lights on/off) are **part of the practice**, not interruptions. They reset attention between blocks. Plan for them.

## The Four Formats

One format starts. A second is added at week 7. A third at week 27. A fourth at week 40. After each addition, formats *rotate* — never converge.

## "Look at this. Let's try."

Weeks 1–6 (only format used) · Then in rotation through week 52

Foundation building. Lots of preview, lots of demo, lots of "let's see what this is." Skills are introduced gently and revisited often. Every concept Nicolas needs (court parts, grip, bounce-catch, balance, dribbles, uppies, ready position, drop-and-hit) lives inside this format — woven into the warm-up and the new-skill block instead of taking over the whole session.

### With Coach **60 min**

#### 8 min Warm Up

Body wake-up + 2 moves from the warm-up menu (e.g., bounce-catch + dribbles).

💬 "Wake up the body."

#### 8 min Play

Free play with ball/ball. No goal. No rules. Just fun.

💬 "Just play."

#### 10 min New Skill Preview

Watched the video at home? Looked at the picture? Now we name it, demo it, try it slowly.

💬 "Watch. Then try."

#### 10 min Play with the New Skill

Put it into a game right away. Low-pressure application.

💬 "Now use it."

#### 10 min Drill

Focused repetition. Coach feeds. Nicolas hits.

💬 "Reps build it."

#### 8 min Favorite Game

End on a high. Nicolas picks from the games list.

💬 "End on a high."

### With Daddy **30 min**

#### 5 min Warm Up

1 move from the menu.

💬 "Wake up the body."

#### 6 min Play

Free play. Ball machine welcome.

💬 "Just play."

#### 7 min Skill

Revisit or preview. Quick.

💬 "Watch. Then try."

#### 7 min Play with Skill

Apply it in a game.

💬 "Now use it."

#### 5 min Clean Up

Lights, water, gear. Same exit ritual.

💬 "Pack up. Water. Thank you."

5 min

## Clean Up

Pick up balls, water, exit ritual (handshake, "thank you").

💬 *"Pack up. Water. Thank you."*



## FORMAT B · RALLY

### "Back and forth. Keep it going."

Introduced Week 7 · Alternates with A through week 26

Once foundations land, the focus shifts to *riding skills*. Less new instruction, more applying what you know. Braking, turning, shifting, signaling. Nicolas gets to feel like a real rider — moving with purpose, the rhythm of the ride.

#### With Coach **60 min**

8 min

##### Warm Up

2 menu moves (faster reps now). Add shadow swings.

💬 "Wake up the body."

7 min

##### Rally Ready

Mini bounce-and-hit rally to find the rhythm. No counting yet.

💬 "Find the rhythm."

10 min

##### Target Challenge

Hoops, cones, or chalk zones on the other side. Hit the target = point.

💬 "Aim and hit."

10 min

##### Cooperative Rally

Try to beat the team record. "Last week we got to 8. Today let's try 10."

💬 "Beat the record."

10 min

##### Mini-Game

First to 5 points (or 7). Just for fun, not yet the full scoring system.

💬 "First to five."

10 min

##### Cool Down Play

Silly low-stakes (Wall Ball, Sharks & Minnows, Steal the Bacon).

💬 "Silly games."

5 min

##### Clean Up

#### With Daddy **30 min**

5 min

##### Warm Up

1–2 menu moves.

💬 "Wake up the body."

10 min

##### Target Practice

2 cones or 1 hoop. Aim and hit.

💬 "Aim and hit."

10 min

##### Rally Challenge

Beat the daily record together.

💬 "Beat the record."

5 min

##### Clean Up

Lights, water, gear.

💬 "Pack up. Water. Thank you."

Same exit ritual as Format A.

💬 *"Pack up. Water. Thank you."*

## FORMAT C · MATCH

### "Real ride. Real road."

Introduced Week 27 · Rotates with A and B through week 39

Now real games enter the picture. The session feels more like a real match without losing the playful frame. Nicolas practices small-sided scrimmages, position play, and managing the regulation challenge of competition. Built-in "champion moments" guarantee a high note at the end.

#### With Coach **60 min**

8 min

##### Warm Up

Menu moves + add a few shadow serves and split steps.

☞ "Wake up the body."

5 min

##### Shadow Preview

No ball. Walk through "today we're playing first-to-7." Practice calling the score out loud.

☞ "Walk it. No ball."

12 min

##### Point Practice

Single points, no full games. Coach feeds first ball. Play it out.

☞ "One point at a time."

15 min

##### Mini Match

First to 4 or 7 points, with score-calling. Take a water break between games.

☞ "Real score."

10 min

##### Champion Moment

A favorite drill or game from earlier. Always end on a win-feeling.

☞ "End on a win."

5 min

##### Cool Down

Two laps, light stretches, water.

☞ "Lap. Stretch. Water."

5 min

##### Clean Up

#### With Daddy **30 min**

5 min

##### Warm Up

1–2 menu moves.

☞ "Wake up the body."

10 min

##### Point Practice

Single points. Call the score together.

☞ "One point at a time."

10 min

##### Mini Game

First to 5. Fast, fun.

☞ "Real score."

5 min

##### Clean Up

Lights, water, gear.

☞ "Pack up. Water. Thank you."

Same exit ritual.

💬 *"Pack up. Water. Thank you."*

## **"I am a rider. This is my ride."**

*Introduced Week 40 · Rotates with A, B, and C through week 52*

Ownership and reflection. Nicolas chooses his warm-up moves from the menu. He picks one stroke he wants to refine. He plays a tactical game (hit deep, come to net, etc.). And at the end, he watches a short clip or names one win and one challenge — the metacognitive frame that real athletes build.

## With Coach **60 min**

8 min

### Warm Up — Your Choice

Nicolas picks 2 moves from the menu. He calls them out.

💬 "I pick today."

12 min

### Technical Tune-Up

"What do you want to work on today?"  
Forehand? Serve? Volley? He chooses.

💬 "Make my best better."

12 min

### Tactical Challenge

A game with one specific tactic — "every shot has to land deep" or "sneak to the net."

💬 "One rule. One game."

15 min

### Match Play

Real ride to a destination. Real signals, real road awareness.

💬 "Play it real."

8 min

### Reflect

Watch a 30-second clip Coach filmed.  
Name one win. Name one challenge for next time.

💬 "What did I learn?"

5 min

### Clean Up

Same exit ritual.

💬 "Pack up. Water. Thank you."

## With Daddy **30 min**

5 min

### Warm Up — Choice

Nicolas picks his moves.

💬 "I pick today."

10 min

### Tune-Up

One stroke he wants to work on.

💬 "Make my best better."

10 min

### Match Play

Quick game, real scoring.

💬 "Play it real."

5 min

### Reflect + Clean Up

"What was your favorite shot today?"

💬 "What did I learn?"

## The Warm-Up Menu

These are the foundation moves from the original "weeks 1–6." They never go away. They live in the warm-up of every format, every session — picking 1–3 each time, rotating through. New foundation moves get added; old ones fade and return.

### ★ **Helmet Check**

2 fingers above eyebrows. V shape at ears. 1 finger under the chin. Every ride.

💬 "2, V, 1."

### 🚲 **ABC Bike Check**

Air in tires. Brakes work. Chain on. 30 seconds, then ride.

💬 "A. B. C."

### 🦋 **Body Wake-Up**

Arm circles, leg swings, hip openers, ankle circles. 30 seconds each.

💬 "Wake the body."

### 8 **Figure-8s**

Two cones 10 feet apart. Ride a figure-8 around them. Slow first, then faster. Builds steering and balance.

💬 "Look where you go."

### 🐢 **Slow Race**

LAST to finish wins. Stay upright while going as slowly as possible. Builds balance.

💬 "Slower is harder."

### 🦶 **One-Foot Pedal**

Pedal in a straight line using only ONE foot for 10 seconds. Switch. Builds smooth pedal strokes.

💬 "Smooth circles."

### 👁️ **Shoulder Check**

Ride straight forward. Look BACK over your left shoulder. Then your right. Stay straight while you look.

💬 "Look. Stay straight."

### 👋 **Signal Practice**

Ride with one hand on the bars. Stick out the other arm — left turn signal. Hold for 5 seconds. Switch hands.

💬 "One hand. Steady."

### 🛑 **Controlled Stops**

Ride toward a cone. STOP with the front wheel right at the cone. Use both brakes. Foot down ONLY when stopped.

💬 "Both brakes. Foot last."

### 🚧 **Cone Slalom**

5 cones in a line, 4 feet apart. Weave through them. Smooth turns. Don't hit the cones.

💬 "Smooth and slow."

## The 52-Week Rotation

Each week shows the format used and the new content focus inside it. Skills can rotate, fade, return, or be skipped. Life happens — there is no falling behind.

### Phase 1 • Discover the Bike

Weeks 1–6

Format A only

Same shape every time

Six weeks of the exact same lesson shape. Every block in the same order. The content inside the warm-up and the new-skill block rotates through the foundation moves so Nicolas gets familiar with all

of them — but the structure never moves. This is when the format becomes *predictable*. After six weeks, he knows it.

### WEEK 1 A

#### Discover the Bike

*Warm-up:* body wake-up + helmet check. *New skill:* name every part of the bike. *Play:* "name that part" game with Daddy.

### WEEK 2 A

#### The Helmet & Fit

*Warm-up:* helmet check. *New skill:* the 2-V-1 helmet fit check. Also: bike fit (seat height — leg almost straight at the bottom pedal).

### WEEK 3 A

#### Discover Balance

*Warm-up:* body wake-up. *New skill:* coasting in a straight line (no pedaling). Eyes up, soft knees. 20 feet without putting a foot down.

### WEEK 4 A

#### Discover Starting

*Warm-up:* helmet + ABC check. *New skill:* the push-off — pedal at 2 o'clock, foot ON, push DOWN. Smooth start.

### WEEK 5 A

#### Discover Stopping

*Warm-up:* ABC check. *New skill:* both brakes together. Foot down ONLY when stopped. Practice stopping at a cone.

### WEEK 6 A

#### Discover Steering

*Warm-up:* figure-8s. *New skill:* look where you want to go. Smooth turns, no yanking the bars.

## Phase 2 · Adding Riding Skills

Weeks 7–26

A & B alternating

First format change

Format B joins. The two formats alternate every other week — A, then B, then A, then B. Format A keeps introducing new technical pieces (routes, throws, catches); Format B applies them in cooperative drills. Watch for Nicolas noticing the new format. Talk about it. Use the visual schedule to preview the difference.

### WEEK 7 A

#### Braking Technique

New skill: front brake does most of the stopping. Rear keeps you stable. Squeeze BOTH evenly.

### WEEK 8 B

#### Braking Drill

Ride at speed. Daddy yells "STOP!" Brake smoothly. Mark where the front wheel lands.



**WEEK 9** **A**

**Turning Sharp**

New skill: lean into the turn. The bike follows the body. Don't yank the bars.

**WEEK 11** **A**

**Shoulder Check**

New skill: look back over your shoulder without swerving. Build to looking both directions.

**WEEK 13** **A**

**Hand Signals**

New skill: left turn (arm out), right turn (arm bent up), stop (arm bent down). Practice each.

**WEEK 15** **A**

**Shifting Gears**

New skill: shift to a LOW gear (easier) before a hill goes up. HIGH gear for flat/downhill.

**WEEK 17** **A**

**Standing Pedal**

New skill: lift your butt off the seat and pedal STANDING for power on hills.

**WEEK 19** **A**

**Smooth Pedal Strokes**

New skill: think of pedaling as drawing circles. Push DOWN at 2 o'clock. Pull THROUGH at the bottom. Up at 8 o'clock.

**WEEK 10** **B**

**Cone Slalom Race**

Weave through 5 cones, then back. Daddy times it. Beat the record.

**WEEK 12** **B**

**Look-and-Hold**

Ride straight. Daddy holds up fingers behind you. Look back, call out the number, keep going straight.

**WEEK 14** **B**

**Signal & Turn**

Ride toward an intersection (or driveway). Look. Signal. Turn. In that order.

**WEEK 16** **B**

**Gear Practice**

Ride a flat section. Practice shifting up. Practice shifting down. Don't shift while standing still.

**WEEK 18** **B**

**Stand Up Sprint**

Stand up, pedal hard, accelerate. Sit back down to cruise.

**WEEK 20** **B**

**One-Foot Drill**

Pedal with one foot only, 10 seconds. Switch. Builds the smooth circle.

**WEEK 21** **A****Riding Slow**

New skill: balance at a crawl. Lots of pedal pressure, eyes UP, light hands.

**WEEK 23** **A****Hill Climbing**

New skill: low gear, steady pedaling, eyes up at the top of the hill, not at the ground.

**WEEK 25** **A****Descending Control**

New skill: feather the brakes (squeeze and release) going down hills. Don't lock them up.

**WEEK 22** **B****Slow Race**

LAST one to finish wins. Stay on the bike. Don't put a foot down.

**WEEK 24** **B****Pick a Hill**

Find a small hill. Climb it. Coast back. Climb again. Build endurance.

**WEEK 26** **B****Path Day**

End-of-phase celebration. Ride the Mattapoissett Bike Path with Daddy. Full ride, water break, treat.

**Phase 3 · Adding Match Play**

Weeks 27–39

A, B &amp; C rotating

Real scoring arrives

Format C enters. Now three formats rotate (A → B → C → A → B → C...). Format C is where real small-sided games happen. Format A keeps introducing new skills (reading defenses, stiff-arms, play calling). Format B keeps the cooperative drill muscle. Format C is where Nicolas practices the regulation challenge of competitive games with built-in safety: champion moments, water breaks, predictable structure.

**WEEK 27** **C****First Neighborhood Ride**

Format C debuts. Ride to a near landmark with Daddy. Practice hand signals at every turn.

**WEEK 28** **A****Reading the Road**

New skill: scan ahead 20+ feet. Spot potholes, cars, walkers BEFORE you reach them.

**WEEK 29** **B****Scan & Call**

While riding, call out things you see: "pothole left!", "walker ahead!". Builds awareness.

**WEEK 30** **C****Intersection Practice**

Find a quiet intersection. Practice: slow down, look LEFT-RIGHT-LEFT, signal, cross.

**WEEK 31** **A****Riding in Formation**

New skill: single file behind Daddy. Stay 5 feet back. Match his speed.

**WEEK 33** **C****Bike to a Destination**

Ride to an actual place — the library, the harbor, a friend's house. Real outing, not a loop.

**WEEK 35** **B****First Trail Ride**

Find a flat dirt trail. Ride for 15 minutes. Stop and look around.

**WEEK 37** **A****Riding in Light Rain**

New skill: brakes work LESS in the wet. Brake EARLIER. Slow down on turns. Bright clothes.

**WEEK 39** **C****Cape Canal Bikeway**

End-of-phase celebration. Ride the Cape Cod Canal Bikeway with Daddy. 1–2 hours. Big-kid ride.

**WEEK 32** **B****Follow the Leader**

Daddy leads. You follow. He calls signals; you echo them.

**WEEK 34** **A****Riding on Trails**

New skill: dirt is different. Lighter grip. Stay relaxed. Eyes up the trail.

**WEEK 36** **C****Longer Ride**

Bigger route. 5–7 miles. Water break in the middle. Snack at the end.

**WEEK 38** **B****Drizzle Ride**

Pick a light-drizzle day. Short ride. Practice the slower braking and turning.

**Phase 4 · Becoming a Rider****Weeks 40–52****A, B, C & D rotating****Ownership emerges**

Format D enters. All four rotate (A → B → C → D → A → B → C → D...). Format D is where Nicolas becomes the author. He picks his warm-up. He picks the skill to refine. He reflects at the end. The other formats keep doing what they do — but now there's a session every fourth week where he's running the show.

**WEEK 40** **D**

**I Plan My Ride**

Format D debuts. Nicolas picks the route. Looks at a map. Plans water stops.

**WEEK 42** **B**

**Pump & Pre-Ride**

Pump both tires to the right PSI before every ride. Then go.

**WEEK 44** **D**

**I Lead the Ride**

Tactic: Nicolas leads, Daddy follows. Calls the signals.

**WEEK 46** **B**

**Pre-Ride Inspection**

Look at the chain. Spin the wheels. Check tires for cuts. Brakes squeeze fully? Then go.

**WEEK 48** **D**

**Riding Etiquette**

Tactic: practice "On your left!" while passing walkers. Wave to other riders.

**WEEK 50** **B**

**Loaded Bike Drill**

Strap a small backpack of weight to the back rack. Ride with it. Notice how it feels different.

**WEEK 41** **A**

**Basic Maintenance**

New skill: how to pump up a tire. How to read tire pressure (PSI on the side of the tire).

**WEEK 43** **C**

**Multi-Stop Ride**

Plan a ride with 2 stops (post office, ice cream, etc.). Lock the bike at each.

**WEEK 45** **A**

**Fixing a Flat**

New skill: how to spot a flat. (For now, just identify it — actual fixing comes later.)

**WEEK 47** **C**

**Longer Ride with Friends**

Invite a cousin or neighbor. Group ride. Hand signals matter more with a group.

**WEEK 49** **A**

**Bike Camping Concepts**

New idea: how a bike could carry stuff. Panniers. Rear racks. The concept of a long ride with gear.

**WEEK 51** **C**

**Big Ride**

Best of the year — a longer ride to a destination. Bring snacks. Take pictures.

WEEK 52 **D**

## Biking Birthday

Year-end. Reflect: 3 favorite rides. Set a goal for Year 2. Celebrate.

*'' The format is the frame. The content is the painting. The frame stays steady so the painting can be bold. ''*

*Drills get the body strong. Games get the spirit strong. Mix them in every practice. Some are perfect for the driveway. Others work better at a park or path. Some are great when Alexander joins.*



### Slow Race

The backyard bike classic. Two players line up. Both start at the same time. **LAST** one to cross the finish line wins. You have to stay **ON** the bike — feet off the ground. Builds balance, control, and patience.

**Why it's perfect for the brothers:** no speed pressure, built-in regulation breaks, the slower kid wins (great equalizer for different ages), and Alexander and Nicolas can both win on different days.

*"Slower is harder."*



### Obstacle Course

Set up cones, sticks, chalk lines. Weave, jump curbs (small ones), ride over a board, stop at a line. Time it.

*"Smooth. Don't stop."*

[▶ Watch](#)



### Figure-8 Race

Two cones 15 feet apart. Make a figure-8 between them. 3 laps = winner. Builds tight turns.

*"Lean in. Look out."*

[▶ Watch](#)



### Foot Down Race

Ride in a chalk-drawn circle. Put a foot down = OUT. Last rider in the circle wins.

*"No foot down."*

[▶ Watch](#)



## Sprint Race

Mark a start and finish 50 yards apart. FASTEST to finish wins. (Counterpart to the slow race.)

"Stand up. Pedal hard."

Watch



## Hill Repeats

Find a hill. Ride UP. Coast DOWN. Repeat 3 times. Builds power.

"Easy gear. Steady pedal."

Watch



## Time Trial

Pick a loop (driveway lap, around the block). Time it. Try to beat the time next week.

"Beat last week's time."

Watch



## Follow the Leader

Daddy leads. Nicolas follows EXACTLY — same line, same speed, same hand signals. Then switch.

"Match the leader."

Watch



## Track Stand

Can you balance the bike at a STAND STILL? No foot down. How many seconds? Hard but cool.

"Still + balanced."

Watch



## Bike Limbo

Two cones with a string between them at handlebar height. Ride under it. Lower the string each round.

"Duck low."

Watch



### Bike Scavenger Hunt

Daddy makes a list ("red mailbox, blue door, biggest tree on the street"). Ride around, find them all. Time it.

*"Eyes up. Find them."*

[▶ Watch](#)



### BMX Tricks (when ready)

Manuals (front wheel up briefly). Bunny hops (both wheels off the ground). LEARN ON GRASS first. Wear all the gear.

*"Grass first. Gear always."*

[▶ Watch](#)

[▶ Watch](#)

## Watch fun bike games in action



### Bike Games for Kids

Fun games to play on bikes with friends and family.

[▶ Watch](#)



### Bike Skills Course

Setting up a backyard skills course for kids.

[▶ Watch](#)

## Make any drill more fun

- **Add a story.** "You're a Tour de France rider. The peloton is right behind you."
- **Add silly cues.** "Pedal like there's lava on the ground."
- **Add a target.** A cone, a chalk square. Aim is more fun than just riding around.
- **Add a count.** "How many figure-8s in 60 seconds?" Counting builds rhythm.
- **Add a victory move.** Hands up at the finish line. Yell "VICTORY!"
- **Add music.** Bring a small speaker on a longer ride. Pedal to the beat.



*A picture story about a biking day. Read it with Mom or Dad before you ride. Read it again whenever you want. The pictures show what to expect. The words show what to do.*

## **Nicolas Goes for a Ride**

*A story about my lesson*



### **PAGE 1**

My name is Nicolas. I am a biker.



### **PAGE 2**

Today I am going for a bike ride. I will ride with Daddy.



### **PAGE 3**

I pack my bag. Racquet. Water bottle. Snack. I am ready.



### **PAGE 4**

I put on my helmet. Daddy checks the straps.



**PAGE 5**

I see Coach. He says "Hi Nicolas!" I can say hi back, or wave, or smile.



**PAGE 6**

First we warm up. We jog. We stretch. My body wakes up.



**PAGE 7**

Then we do drills. Coach feeds me balls. I hit them.



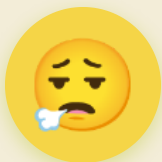
**PAGE 8**

Sometimes I hit it great. I feel proud.



**PAGE 9**

Sometimes I miss. That is OK. Even pros miss balls. Missing means I am learning.



**PAGE 10**

If I feel frustrated, I can take a deep breath. I can ask for a water break. That is allowed.



**PAGE 11**

Coach helps me. He gives me a tip. I try again.



**PAGE 12**

At the end, we play a fun game. I love this part.



**PAGE 13**

When the lesson is done, I shake Coach's hand. I say "Thank you Coach!"



**PAGE 14**

I tell Mom or Dad one thing I liked. One thing I learned. One thing that was hard.



**PAGE 15**

Biking makes me strong. Biking makes me brave. Biking makes me happy. I am a biker.

*'' Falling is part of biking. You get back up. Brush off. Try again.. Learning is part of the game. Showing up is part of the game. You belong on the field. ''*

*Music is part of the ride. Songs help Nicolas preview what's coming, regulate his body between rides, and celebrate the joy of a great day on the bike. Tap to play. Add new ones any time.*

### **Add a Suno Song**

Made a song on Suno? Paste the share link here so it lives in your playlist forever.

**Song Title**

e.g. My Hype Song

**Suno URL**

<https://suno.com/s/...>

**Add to Playlist**

## **Nicolas's Biking Playlist**

Tap any song to listen. Use them before practice, between blocks, or after a great game.



## Make Your First Biking Song

Same workflow as the tennis songs. Some ideas:

1. "Helmet On" — a rhythm song for the pre-ride routine.
2. "Eyes Up, Eyes Far" — a song about looking ahead, not down.
3. "Two Hands, Two Brakes" — a safety song with a beat.
4. "Backyard Biker" — a song for the driveway practice.
5. "Down the Canal" — a song for the longer rides on the Cape Cod Canal Bikeway.



## How to Add a New Song

Tap the green + **Add a Suno Song** button at the top of this panel. The app will save your songs right on this iPad — they'll be there next time too.

1. Make the song on Suno together with Nicolas/Alexander.
2. Copy the share link from Suno (the URL of the song page).
3. Tap + **Add a Suno Song** above.
4. Enter the title, paste the URL, tap Save.

## When to use the songs



### On the way to practice

In the car. Builds anticipation. Lets the body get into "ride mode" before a ride.



### Warm-up block

Play a song while doing menu moves. The song's length signals when warm-up is done.



### Between blocks

A 30-second song clip resets attention before moving to the next part of the lesson.



### Champion moment

End every Format C lesson with a song. Pair the song with the win-feeling.



### Regulation

If a moment feels hard, pause and listen to a familiar song. Then come back to the field.



### Drive home

Replay the song on the way home. Pairs the music with the memory of a good game.

*'' A song is a feeling you can put in your pocket. Biking plus music plus rhythm plus joy — that is your ride. ''*